

Word family: **proceed / proceeds / proceeded / proceeding / proceedings**

Base word: proceed

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

* **proceed** (v.) — 繼續進行；著手；前往；發生 / 源自

* **proceeding** (n.) — 行動；程序；一項法律程序（較正式）

* **proceedings** (plural n.) — 訴訟程序；會議紀錄 / 議事過程；論文集

* **proceeds** (plural n.) — 收益；所得款項

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **proceed with something**

* **proceed to do something**

* **proceed as planned**

* **proceed as usual**

* **proceed cautiously**

* **proceed in a direction**

* **proceed along / through / towards**

* **proceed to a place**

* **proceed without delay**

* **proceed from something**

* **proceed against someone**

* **legal proceedings**

* **disciplinary proceedings**

* **criminal proceedings**

* **the proceedings of a meeting**

* **conference proceedings**

* **sale proceeds**

* **proceeds from a sale**

* **net proceeds**

* **all proceeds go to charity**

Meaning in this passage

> If tasks are vaguely assigned, employees may duplicate work, overlook crucial details or
proceed in completely different directions.

Here, **proceed** means:

to continue carrying out the work or move forward with it in a particular way — 繼續進行；按某個方向推進

Because the tasks are unclear, different employees may understand the assignment differently and continue working according to completely different plans or approaches.

****中文翻譯：****

如果任務分配得含糊不清，員工可能會重複工作、忽略重要細節，或者****各自朝完全不同的方向繼續進行工作****。

So here:

****proceed in different directions = 各人按照不同的理解、方法或目標繼續推進工作****

1. ****proceed (繼續進行；向前推進) — 繼續進行；推進****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Employees may ****proceed in completely different directions****.

員工可能會****各自朝完全不同的方向繼續進行工作****。

Practice 2

> Once the roles are clear, the team can ****proceed more efficiently****.

角色一旦清晰，團隊便可以更有效率地****繼續推進工作****。

Practice 3

> We should not ****proceed**** until everyone understands the objective.

在每個人都明白目標之前，我們不應****繼續進行****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proceed = 在某項工作、計劃或活動中繼續向下一步推進****

2. ****proceed in a particular direction — 朝某方向前進 / 發展****

Very relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> The two departments **proceeded in different directions**.

兩個部門**朝不同方向推進工作**。

Practice 2

> Without clear instructions, the discussion may **proceed in the wrong direction**.

如果沒有清晰指示，討論可能會**朝錯誤方向發展**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed in a direction = 按某種路線、方法或思路繼續前進

3. **proceed with something — 繼續 / 著手進行某事**

A major grammar pattern.

Practice 1

> The team decided to **proceed with the original plan**.

團隊決定**繼續執行原來的計劃**。

Practice 2

> We cannot **proceed with the project** until the budget is approved.

在預算獲批准之前，我們不能**繼續推進項目**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed with X = 開始或繼續進行 X

4. **proceed to do something — 接着做某事**

Another major grammar pattern.

Practice 1

> After reviewing the data, the team **proceeded to prepare the report**.

檢視數據後，團隊**接着準備報告**。

Practice 2

> She explained the problem and then **proceeded to suggest a solution**.

她解釋問題後，**接着提出了解決方案**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed to do X = 完成前一件事後，接着進行 X

5. **proceed as planned — 按計劃進行**

Practice 1

> The meeting will **proceed as planned**.

會議將**按原定計劃進行**。

Practice 2

> Despite the delay, the project **proceeded as planned**.

儘管有所延誤，項目仍然**按計劃推進**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed as planned = 按原先安排繼續進行，沒有作重大改變

6. **proceed as usual — 如常進行**

Practice 1

> Work will **proceed as usual** tomorrow.

明天工作會**如常進行**。

Practice 2

> The event **proceeded as usual** despite the minor problem.

儘管出現小問題，活動仍然**照常進行**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proceed as usual = 按平常方式繼續，沒有特別改變****

7. ****proceed cautiously / carefully — 謹慎進行****

Practice 1

> The team decided to ****proceed cautiously****.

團隊決定****謹慎推進****。

Practice 2

> We should ****proceed carefully**** until more information is available.

在有更多資料之前，我們應該****小心進行****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proceed cautiously = 繼續進行，但保持小心並避免風險****

8. ****proceed without delay — 立即繼續進行****

Practice 1

> Once approval is received, we can ****proceed without delay****.

一旦獲得批准，我們便可以****立即繼續進行****。

Practice 2

> The repair work should ****proceed without further delay****.

維修工作應該****不要再拖延，立即繼續****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proceed without delay = 不再等待，立即開始或繼續****

9. ****proceed (前往；向前走) — 前往；繼續往前****

A major physical-movement sense.

Practice 1

> Please **proceed to the next room**.

請**前往下一個房間**。

Practice 2

> Passengers should **proceed to Gate 12**.

乘客請**前往 12 號閘口**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proceed to a place = 前往某個地方，通常較正式****

10. **proceed along / through / towards — 沿着 / 穿過 / 朝向.....前進**

Practice 1

> Please **proceed along the corridor**.

請**沿着走廊前行**。

Practice 2

> The group **proceeded through the entrance**.

一行人**穿過入口繼續前進**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****proceed along/through/towards X = 以較正式語氣表示沿某路線移動****

11. **proceed to the exit / gate / platform — 前往出口 / 閘口 / 月台**

Practice 1

> Please **proceed to the nearest exit**.

請**前往最近的出口**。

Practice 2

> Passengers may now **proceed to the platform**.

乘客現在可以**前往月台**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed to X = 正式指示某人前往某地

Common in:

- * airports,
- * stations,
- * official announcements,
- * formal instructions.

12. **proceed (活動正式開始 / 繼續) — 進行**

Practice 1

> The meeting **proceeded smoothly**.

會議**順利進行**。

Practice 2

> The ceremony **proceeded without interruption**.

儀式**順利進行**，沒有受到干擾。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed = 活動、會議或過程持續進行

13. **proceed smoothly — 順利進行**

Practice 1

> Clear communication helped the project **proceed smoothly**.

清晰溝通令項目得以**順利進行**。

Practice 2

> The interview **proceeded smoothly**.

面試**進行得很順利**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed smoothly = 過程沒有重大問題或中斷

14. **proceed normally — 正常進行**

Practice 1

> Operations can now **proceed normally**.

運作現在可以**恢復正常進行**。

Practice 2

> The experiment **proceeded normally** after the equipment was repaired.

設備修好後，實驗**正常進行**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed normally = 按正常程序持續進行

15. **proceed from something — 源自；由……產生**

A genuinely distinct formal sense.

Practice 1

> The misunderstanding **proceeded from unclear instructions**.

這個誤會**源自不清晰的指示**。

Practice 2

> His conclusion **proceeded from a false assumption**.

他的結論**源自一個錯誤假設**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed from X = formal: 起因於 X；由 X 產生或發展出來

16. **proceed from one idea to another — 從一個概念推進到另一個概念**

Practice 1

> The argument **proceeds from general principles to specific examples**.

論點**由一般原則逐步推進至具體例子**。

Practice 2

> The course **proceeds from basic concepts to advanced applications**.

課程**由基本概念逐步進展至進階應用**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed from A to B = 從 A 按次序發展或推進到 B

17. **proceed against someone — 對某人採取法律 / 正式行動**

A major formal/legal sense.

Practice 1

> The company decided to **proceed against the contractor legally**.

公司決定**對承辦商採取法律行動**。

Practice 2

> Authorities may **proceed against individuals who break the regulations**.

當局可能會**對違反規例的人採取正式行動**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceed against someone = formal/legal: 對某人展開法律或紀律程序

18. **legal proceedings — 法律程序；訴訟**

A very important noun-family extension.

Practice 1

> The company began **legal proceedings** against the supplier.

公司開始對供應商展開**法律程序**。

Practice 2

> The dispute eventually led to **legal proceedings**.

爭議最終導致**訴訟程序**。

MCQ-ready definition:

legal proceedings = 法院或其他法律機構正式處理案件的一系列程序

19. **criminal proceedings** — 刑事訴訟程序

Practice 1

> **Criminal proceedings** were started against the suspect.

當局對疑犯展開了**刑事訴訟程序**。

Practice 2

> The evidence may be used in **criminal proceedings**.

這些證據可能會用於**刑事法律程序**。

MCQ-ready definition:

criminal proceedings = 與刑事罪行有關的正式法律程序

20. **civil proceedings** — 民事訴訟程序

Practice 1

> The company may face **civil proceedings**.

公司可能面臨**民事訴訟**。

Practice 2

> They started **civil proceedings** to recover the money.

他們展開**民事法律程序**以追回款項。

MCQ-ready definition:

civil proceedings = 處理非刑事法律爭議的正式訴訟程序

21. **disciplinary proceedings — 紀律程序**

Practice 1

> The employee faced **disciplinary proceedings**.

該員工面臨**紀律程序**。

Practice 2

> Serious misconduct may result in formal **disciplinary proceedings**.

嚴重不當行為可能導致正式的**紀律處分程序**。

MCQ-ready definition:

disciplinary proceedings = 組織正式調查並處理可能違反規則行為的程序

22. **proceedings (會議 / 活動的過程) — 議事過程 ; 會議進程**

Practice 1

> The chair opened the **proceedings**.

主席宣布**議事程序 / 會議正式開始**。

Practice 2

> She watched the **proceedings** from the back of the room.

她在房間後方觀看整個**會議進程**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceedings = 正式會議、典禮或其他活動中的一連串行動和程序

23. **the proceedings of a meeting — 會議過程 / 議事內容**

Practice 1

> A written record of the **proceedings** was kept.

會議的**議事過程**有書面紀錄。

Practice 2

> Several interruptions delayed the **proceedings**.

數次中斷拖延了**會議進程**。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceedings = 正式活動中實際發生的各項程序和事件

24. **conference proceedings — 會議論文集；學術會議紀錄**

A major academic sense.

Practice 1

> The paper was published in the **conference proceedings**.

這篇論文刊登於**學術會議論文集**。

Practice 2

> The proceedings contain papers from researchers around the world.

這份**會議論文集**收錄了世界各地研究人員的論文。

MCQ-ready definition:

conference proceedings = 學術會議上發表的論文或正式內容所編成的出版物

25. **proceeds (所得款項；收益) — 收益；所得款項**

A completely separate plural noun sense.

Practice 1

> The **proceeds from the sale** will be donated.

出售所得的**款項**將會捐出。

Practice 2

> The company used the **proceeds** to repay debt.

公司用這筆**所得款項**償還債務。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceeds = 出售物品、舉辦活動或進行交易後得到的金錢

Important: this noun is normally **plural in form**.

26. **proceeds from a sale — 出售所得款項**

Practice 1

> The **proceeds from the property sale** were divided equally.

出售物業所得的**款項**被平均分配。

Practice 2

> She invested the **proceeds from the sale of her business**.

她把出售公司的**所得款項**拿去投資。

MCQ-ready definition:

proceeds from a sale = 出售某項資產後取得的金錢

27. **all proceeds go to charity — 所有收益撥捐慈善用途**

Practice 1

> **All proceeds will go to charity**.

所有收益將撥捐慈善用途。

Practice 2

> The concert was organised so that **all proceeds** went to a local charity.

音樂會的**所有收益**都撥捐給本地慈善機構。

MCQ-ready definition:

all proceeds go to X = 活動或銷售所得的全部金錢會交給 X

28. **net proceeds** — 淨收益；淨所得款項

Practice 1

> The **net proceeds** were lower after expenses were deducted.

扣除開支後，**淨收益**較低。

Practice 2

> The company received £2 million in **net proceeds**.

公司獲得二百萬英鎊的**淨所得款項**。

MCQ-ready definition:

net proceeds = 扣除相關成本和費用後剩下的實際所得款項

29. **gross proceeds** — 總收益；未扣成本的所得款項

Practice 1

> Gross **proceeds** from the event reached \$100,000.

活動的**總收益**達十萬元。

Practice 2

> Fees are deducted from the **gross proceeds**.

費用會從**總所得款項**中扣除。

MCQ-ready definition:

gross proceeds = 尚未扣除成本、費用等之前的全部所得款項

Important distinction 1: **proceed** vs **continue**

This is the most important distinction.

continue

very broad and neutral: keep doing something.

proceed

more formal and often suggests:

- * moving to the next stage,
- * following a procedure,
- * continuing after a pause or decision.

> continue working

> 繼續工作

> proceed with the project

> **繼續 / 正式推進項目**

In your passage, **proceed** sounds slightly more formal and process-oriented.

Important distinction 2: **proceed** vs **progress**

Easy to confuse.

proceed

continue or move forward with an activity.

progress

develop toward a better, later, or more complete stage.

> The meeting proceeded slowly.

> 會議進行得很慢。

> The project progressed slowly.

> 項目進展緩慢。

A process can **proceed** without necessarily making good **progress**.

Important distinction 3: **proceed** vs **move forward**

move forward

common and flexible, often figurative.

proceed

more formal and procedural.

> Let's move forward with the plan.

> 我們繼續推進計劃吧。

> We have permission to proceed.

> 我們已獲批准**繼續進行**。

Important distinction 4: **proceed** vs **go ahead**

go ahead

more conversational.

proceed

more formal.

> Go ahead with the meeting.

> 照常開會吧。

> Proceed with the meeting.

> **繼續進行會議。**

Same core idea, different register.

Important distinction 5: **proceed with** vs **proceed to**

Very important grammar distinction.

proceed with + noun

continue/start an activity:

> proceed with the project

> 繼續進行項目

proceed to + verb

next do something:

> proceed to discuss the results

> 接着討論結果

Do not mix these structures.

Important distinction 6: **proceed to + place vs proceed to + verb**

Same form, different grammar:

Place:

> proceed to Gate 5

> 前往 5 號閘口

Verb:

> proceed to explain

> 接着解釋

Context tells you whether **to** introduces:

* destination, or

* infinitive verb.

Important distinction 7: **proceed vs begin**

begin

start.

proceed

may start after permission, preparation, or a previous stage, or simply continue.

> The meeting began at 9.

> 會議九時開始。

> After introductions, we proceeded to the main discussion.

> 介紹後，我們**接着進入主要討論**。

Important distinction 8: **proceed vs resume**

resume

start again after stopping.

proceed

continue generally; there may or may not have been a pause.

> The meeting resumed after lunch.

> 午飯後會議**恢復進行**。

> The meeting proceeded smoothly.

> 會議**順利進行**。

Important distinction 9: **proceed vs proceed from**

This is a major polysemy split.

proceed

continue:

> We proceeded with the plan.

> 我們繼續執行計劃。

proceed from

originate:

> The problem proceeds from poor communication.

> 問題**源自**溝通不良。

The second is much more formal.

Important distinction 10: **proceed in different directions**

In your passage, this is partly figurative.

It does **not** mean employees literally walk away in different physical directions.

It means:

different workers adopt different interpretations, strategies, priorities, or methods

For example:

- * one designs slides,
- * another rewrites the report,
- * another researches unrelated data,

because nobody clarified what each person should do.

Important distinction 11: **proceed vs approach**

approach a task

begin dealing with it in a particular way.

proceed with a task

continue actually carrying it out.

So:

> approach = method/starting orientation

> proceed = ongoing movement through the task

Important distinction 12: **proceedings vs process**

process

general sequence of stages.

proceedings

usually formal actions/events, especially:

- * legal,
- * disciplinary,
- * meeting-related.

> recruitment process

> 招聘程序

> legal proceedings

> 法律訴訟程序

Not interchangeable in many contexts.

Important distinction 13: **proceedings is normally plural**

For the common legal/event sense:

> legal proceedings ✓

> disciplinary proceedings ✓

A singular **proceeding** exists, especially for one particular formal/legal action, but learners will see the plural far more often.

Important distinction 14: **proceeds vs proceedings**

Very easy to confuse.

proceeds

money received:

> proceeds from the sale

> 出售所得款項

proceedings

formal procedures/events:

- > court proceedings
- > 法院程序

One small ending makes a completely different meaning.

Important distinction 15: **proceeds vs profit**

proceeds

money received from the sale/activity.

profit

money remaining after relevant costs are subtracted.

Example:

- > Sale proceeds = \$100,000
- > Costs = \$70,000
- > Profit = \$30,000

So **proceeds** $\neq$ **profit**.

Important distinction 16: **gross proceeds vs net proceeds**

gross proceeds

before deductions.

net proceeds

after specified costs/fees are deducted.

Do not automatically translate both simply as 「利潤」.

They are **款項 / 收益**, not necessarily profit.

Important distinction 17: **proceed against someone**

This is formal.

It does not mean:

> physically move toward someone.

It means:

正式對某人採取法律或紀律行動

Important distinction 18: **conference proceedings**

This does not simply mean:

> what happened during the conference.

In academic publishing, **conference proceedings** often means:

正式出版的會議論文集 / 會議文集

Context matters.

Important distinction 19: **proceed in your passage**

The writer has already given the cause:

> tasks are vaguely assigned.

Then three consequences follow:

1. **duplicate work**
2. **overlook crucial details**
3. **proceed in completely different directions**

The third means employees do not share a coordinated route toward the same objective.

So **proceed** here emphasizes:

continuing action after misunderstanding has already occurred

Family-extension note

The **proceed** family has several important modern branches:

1. **continue with an activity**

- * proceed with a project
- * proceed as planned

2. **move to the next action**

- * proceed to explain
- * proceed to the next stage

3. **move physically**

- * proceed to the gate
- * proceed along the corridor

4. **originate**

- * proceed from an assumption

5. **formal/legal action**

- * proceed against someone
- * legal proceedings

6. **formal meeting/activity events**

- * proceedings of a meeting

7. **academic publishing**

- * conference proceedings

8. **money received**

- * sale proceeds
- * net proceeds

For your passage, the exact branch is:

proceed = continue carrying out work according to a particular direction or approach

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
proceed	繼續進行；推進	continue
proceed in a direction	朝某方向進行	approach/path
proceed with X	繼續 / 著手進行 X	activity
proceed to do X	接著做 X	next action
proceed as planned	按計劃進行	original plan
proceed as usual	如常進行	normal continuation
proceed cautiously	謹慎進行	careful continuation
proceed without delay	立即繼續	no waiting
proceed to a place	前往某地	movement
proceed along/through	沿着 / 穿過前進	route
proceed smoothly	順利進行	process
proceed from X	源自 X	origin
proceed from A to B	由 A 推進至 B	sequence
proceed against someone	對某人採取正式行動	legal/formal
legal proceedings	法律程序；訴訟	law
criminal proceedings	刑事訴訟程序	law
civil proceedings	民事訴訟程序	law
disciplinary proceedings	紀律程序	workplace/institution
proceedings	議事過程；正式程序	event
conference proceedings	會議論文集	academia
proceeds	所得款項；收益	money received
sale proceeds	出售所得款項	sale
net proceeds	淨所得款項	after deductions
gross proceeds	總所得款項	before deductions
all proceeds go to charity	所有收益撥捐慈善	fundraising

For your original sentence

> If tasks are vaguely assigned, employees may duplicate work, overlook crucial details or
proceed in completely different directions.

Here:

**proceed in completely different directions

= 員工因為沒有共同理解任務要求，所以各自按照不同的方法、目標或優先次序繼續工作，最終彼此的工作無法配合**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 如果任務分配得含糊不清，員工可能會重複工作、忽略重要細節，或者**各自朝完全不同的方向進行**。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **continue** = 一般「繼續」

> **resume** = 中斷後恢復

> **progress** = 有進展、向完成方向發展

> **go ahead** = 較口語的「繼續做吧」

> **proceed** = **較正式地繼續進行、進入下一階段或按某個方向推進**

For this passage, **proceed** is especially suitable because the writer is describing employees who are **actively continuing the task—but doing so along incompatible paths**.